Interview Thesis Brief

Director, Artificial Intelligence Technology | Independent candidate brief

Candidate Thesis

The model is not the show. The guest experience is.

Build AI so it becomes invisible in the moment and legible in the operation.

Actual Mandate

Turn distributed AI demand into a governed technical portfolio that produces reliable, adopted and measurable enterprise services.

The director must connect strategy, architecture, data quality, model performance, MLOps, testing, staffing, vendors, responsible AI and business ownership.

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AI Show Contract

Scene: named outcome, operating owner, baseline, workflow and adoption burden.

Cue: data context, model role and limits, human authority, override and escalation.

Run: testing, observability, drift, latency, security, rollback and vendor resilience.

Review: adoption, ROI, trust, incidents, learning, reuse and retirement.

Production Boundary

A technically healthy model without retained use is not value. A popular workflow without controls is not readiness.

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Evidence Map

Vape-Jet: AI-first operating transformation across production, quality, customer, engineering, ERP, CRM and telemetry.

DudeWorth: AI-readiness, agentic workflow design, structured context, retrieval, evaluation and governance.

Amazon: 24/7 operating mechanisms supporting approximately five million second-day orders annually.

Compunetics: engineering, manufacturing, quality and high-reliability technical delivery.

Strongest Objection

I am not presenting myself as a career ML research scientist or claiming a graduate AI degree. My case is connective technical leadership around specialists and production discipline.

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Operating Scorecard

- Guest outcome and service quality.
- Flow, cycle time and exception burden.
- Economics, cost-to-serve and reuse.
- Run-state health, resilience and recovery.
- Trust, control coverage and incidents.
- Adoption, retained use and learning speed.

Decision Rights

- Clarify who owns the outcome, technical service, control approval, release, rollback and retirement.

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Interview Use

Test the mandate, portfolio, architecture, production boundary, team depth, vendor concentration, governance and year-one success conditions.

Listen for implicit ownership, fragmented evidence, production responsibility changing hands, and guest consequences missing from technical decisions.

Closing Position

Universal should hire a technical director who can recruit depth, challenge it intelligently, create production discipline and make AI valuable in the work.